

Chrono Crawler — Tutorial / System UI Text Pack

Controls, Objectives, Hints, System Messages

1. General UI Tone Rules

System UI should sound like the Chrono Core is half machine, half damaged memory.

Use:

- short lines,
- technical language,
- subtle emotional undertone,
- no long explanations during gameplay.

Avoid:

- comedy tutorial text,
- overexplaining mechanics,
- revealing story too early,
- generic “Good job!” language.

Good example:

Checkpoint stabilized.
You may return.
You may not undo.

Bad example:

Nice! You reached a checkpoint. If you die, you will respawn here.

2. Basic Movement Tutorial

Movement Prompt

MOVE

A / D or ← / →

The floor is still real here.

Alternative Movement Prompt

MOVE LEFT / RIGHT

A / D

Begin before the room changes its mind.

Run Prompt

RUN

SHIFT

Some corridors do not stay open.

Jump Prompt

JUMP

SPACE / W / ↑

The city breaks upward too.

Jump Follow-up Hint

Not every gap belongs to the same time.

Crouch / Drop Prompt

If needed later.

DROP THROUGH

S / ↓

Some paths are easier to lose.

3. Interaction Tutorial

Interact Prompt

INTERACT

E

The machine remembers your hands.

Door Interaction

OPEN / USE

E

This door recognizes Varren clearance.

Terminal Interaction

ACCESS TERMINAL

E

Recovered systems may lie.

Object Examine Prompt

EXAMINE

E

Read what the fracture left behind.

4. Timeline Shift Tutorial

First Timeline Shift Unlock

CHRONO CORE PARTIALLY ONLINE

Temporal layers available:

- 1 Past
- 2 Present
- 3 Ruined Future

Q Cycle timeline

First Timeline Shift Explanation

SHIFT TIME LAYER

Q

Same place.
Different damage.

Direct Timeline Prompt

DIRECT LAYER ACCESS

- 1 Past
- 2 Present
- 3 Ruined Future

Choose carefully.
The city remembers each version.

Past Layer UI Text

TEMPORAL LAYER: PAST

Stable.
Clean.
Untrustworthy.

Present Layer UI Text

TEMPORAL LAYER: PRESENT

Current fracture state.

Ruined Future Layer UI Text

TEMPORAL LAYER: RUINED FUTURE

Projected decay.
Do not mistake warning for destination.

Timeline Shift Warning

TEMPORAL STRAIN INCREASED

The Core heard you.

Object State Hint

Objects may exist differently across layers.

A bridge lost here may still remember being whole.

Short Version

Shift time.
Find the version that still holds.

5. Platform / Bridge Tutorial

First Timeline Bridge

BRIDGE STATE: VARIABLE

Past: intact
Present: damaged
Future: failed

Bridge Hint

The bridge is not gone.

You are standing in the wrong when.

Crumbling Platform Hint

STRUCTURE UNSTABLE

Move before the future arrives.

Powered Platform Hint

POWER ROUTE INCOMPLETE

Search another layer.

Powered Platform Active

POWER RESTORED

Platform memory stabilized.

Broken Future Platform

FUTURE DECAY DETECTED

This version will not hold you for long.

6. Door / Gate Tutorial

Locked Door

LOCKED

Clearance accepted.
Timeline state rejected.

Door Timeline Hint

This door was open once.

Find when.

Iron Gate

GATE STATE: SEALED

Mechanical memory required.

Gate Opens

GATE MEMORY RESTORED

Proceed.

Future Door Destroyed

DOOR STATE: FAILED

Destruction is also an opening.

Keeper Barrier

KEEPER BARRIER DETECTED

Correction protocol active.

Keeper Barrier Hint

This barrier does not block the body.

It blocks the decision.

7. Switches / Pressure Plates

Pressure Plate Prompt

PRESSURE PLATE

Requires weight.

Living or remembered.

Pressure Plate Activated

PRESSURE ACCEPTED

Local circuit restored.

Pressure Plate Released

PRESSURE LOST

Memory circuit broken.

Switch Prompt

SWITCH

E

The mechanism waits for instruction.

Switch Activated

SWITCH MEMORY RECORDED

Switch Already Used

STATE ALREADY CHANGED

The machine remembers.

Console Switch

CONSOLE ACCESSIBLE

E

Manual correction available.

8. Echo System Tutorial

Echo Unlock

ECHO RECORDING AVAILABLE

G Start / stop recording

A short version of you may remain.

Echo Basic Explanation

Record your movement.

Replay it.

Let memory stand where you cannot.

Echo Recording Started

ECHO RECORDING STARTED

Do something worth repeating.

Echo Recording Stopped

ECHO RECORDING STORED

Echo Replay Started

ECHO REPLAY ACTIVE

Memory has weight.

Echo Expired

ECHO DISSIPATED

No memory holds forever.

Echo Pressure Plate Hint

Your echo can hold pressure plates.

The Core accepts remembered weight.

Echo Switch Hint

Your echo can repeat switch interactions.

Some doors need you twice.

Echo Limit Warning

ECHO LIMIT REACHED

Eight seconds is all the Core can stomach.

Echo Failed

ECHO FAILED

Recording corrupted.

9. Checkpoint / Rewind Tutorial

Checkpoint First Discovery

CHECKPOINT BEACON DETECTED

Stabilize local return point.

Checkpoint Activated

CHECKPOINT STABILIZED

You may return.
You may not undo.

Rewind Prompt

REWIND TO CHECKPOINT

R

Return to the last stable mistake.

Rewind Used

REWIND COMPLETE

Position restored.
Loss retained.

Death / Respawn Texts

Death 1

SIGNAL LOST

Reconstructing from checkpoint.

Death 2

BODY STATE FAILED

Chrono trace recovered.

Death 3

You fell out of the moment.

Death 4

The city refused that version.

Respawn Text

CHECKPOINT TRACE RESTORED

Try again.
Differently.

10. Objective Updates

Chapter 0 Objectives

OBJECTIVE UPDATED
Find a way out of the laboratory.

OBJECTIVE UPDATED
Reach the Observatory Lift.

OBJECTIVE UPDATED
Follow the fracture.

Chapter 1 Objectives — Old District

OBJECTIVE UPDATED

Cross the Old District.

OBJECTIVE UPDATED

Find the intact path through the Past.

OBJECTIVE UPDATED

Track the secondary chrono signature.

OBJECTIVE UPDATED

Reach the district clock tower.

Chapter 2 Objectives — Rail Line

OBJECTIVE UPDATED

Enter the rail station.

OBJECTIVE UPDATED

Restore platform access.

OBJECTIVE UPDATED

Follow the stopped clocks.

OBJECTIVE UPDATED

Reach Platform 7.

Chapter 3 Objectives — Observatory

OBJECTIVE UPDATED

Enter the Varren Observatory.

OBJECTIVE UPDATED

Recover the archive fragment.

OBJECTIVE UPDATED
Access the private chamber.

OBJECTIVE UPDATED
Descend to the Core.

Final Chapter Objectives — Still Hour

OBJECTIVE UPDATED
Enter the Still Hour.

OBJECTIVE UPDATED
Break the correction loop.

OBJECTIVE UPDATED
Reach the Chrono Core.

OBJECTIVE UPDATED
Cancel the final correction.

11. Chapter Title Cards

Chapter 0

CHAPTER 0
THE HOUR THAT SPLIT

Chapter 1

CHAPTER 1
THE OLD DISTRICT

Where the city remembers itself kindly.

Chapter 2

CHAPTER 2
THE RAIL LINE

All trains arrive.
Not all passengers do.

Chapter 3

CHAPTER 3
THE OBSERVATORY

The sky was never the target.

Final Chapter

FINAL CHAPTER
THE STILL HOUR

The second that refused to end.

Ending Chapter

WHAT REMAINS

Some moments do not open.
They remain.

12. Pause Menu Text

Main Pause Menu

PAUSED

The city waits badly.

Resume
Options

Restart from Checkpoint
Main Menu

Options Menu

OPTIONS

Music Volume
SFX Volume
Fullscreen
Text Speed
Back

Confirm Restart

Return to last checkpoint?

This will restore position.
It will not restore certainty.

Confirm
Cancel

Confirm Main Menu

Leave current run?

Unsaved local changes may be lost.

Confirm
Cancel

13. Save / Continue Text

Save Created

LOCAL SAVE CREATED

The Core remembers this much.

Continue Available

CONTINUE

A previous fracture remains open.

No Save Found

NO SAVE FOUND

Nothing stable enough to return to.

Save Loaded

SAVE TRACE LOADED

Welcome back, Dr. Varren.

14. Settings / Accessibility Text

Text Speed

TEXT SPEED

Let the words arrive slower
or faster than the truth.

Reduced Flash

REDUCED FLASH EFFECTS

For eyes that prefer not to fight the fracture.

High Contrast

HIGH CONTRAST MODE

Make the city easier to read.

Control Remapping

CONTROL REMAPPING

Change the buttons.
Not the consequences.

15. General System Warnings

Warning 1

WARNING
Continuity fault detected.

Warning 2

WARNING
Repeated correction increases future decay.

Warning 3

WARNING
Secondary chrono signature nearby.

Warning 4

WARNING
Anchor response unstable.

Warning 5

WARNING
Layer conflict detected.

Warning 6

WARNING
Do not follow the black coat.

Warning 7

WARNING
The clean version is lying.

Warning 8

WARNING
Core pressure rising.

Warning 9

WARNING
This path has already failed.

Warning 10

WARNING
Future decay has entered current layer.

16. Small Gameplay Hints

Hint 1

Some bridges only exist before they break.

Hint 2

The future is not always a path.
Sometimes it is a warning.

Hint 3

If a door will not open now, ask when it did.

Hint 4

Your echo can hold what you cannot.

Hint 5

The Past is stable, not honest.

Hint 6

The Present is real, not safe.

Hint 7

The Future is broken, not empty.

Hint 8

Machines remember states.
People remember pain.

Hint 9

Not every locked door wants a key.

Hint 10

A second version of you may be enough.

17. Loading Screen Tips

Loading Tip 1

Shift between Past, Present, and Ruined Future to change the world around you.

Loading Tip 2

Echoes repeat your recorded movement and interactions.

Loading Tip 3

A pressure plate does not care whether the weight is alive.

Loading Tip 4

Some doors are destroyed in the future.
Destruction can be useful.

Loading Tip 5

The cleanest version of a place may hide the ugliest truth.

Loading Tip 6

The Later Man knows too much.
Listen anyway.

Loading Tip 7

If a path is impossible, try a different layer.

Loading Tip 8

Checkpoint rewind restores your position, not the story.

Loading Tip 9

Not every message from the Core is meant to help you.

Loading Tip 10

Follow the fracture.
Distrust the reason.

18. UI Labels

Timeline Labels

PAST

PRESENT

RUINED FUTURE

STILL HOUR

Action Labels

MOVE

RUN

JUMP

INTERACT

SHIFT

RECORD ECHO

REPLAY ECHO

REWIND

PAUSE

Object Labels

DOOR

GATE

SWITCH

PRESSURE PLATE

CHECKPOINT

TERMINAL

ARCHIVE

ELEVATOR

CORE ACCESS

Status Labels

STABLE

UNSTABLE

LOCKED

OPEN

FAILED

DAMAGED

CORRUPTED

RESTORED

PENDING

UNKNOWN

19. Boss / Final Puzzle UI Text

Keeper Barrier

KEEPER PROTOCOL ACTIVE

Final correction protected.

Barrier Phase 1

ANCHOR REQUIRED

Barrier Phase 2

ECHO ACCEPTED

Barrier Phase 3

MEMORY CONFLICT DETECTED

Barrier Weakens

KEEPER BARRIER WEAKENED

Final Correction Prompt

FINAL CORRECTION AVAILABLE

Activate?

Cancel Correction Prompt

CANCEL FINAL CORRECTION?

This cannot be reversed.

Confirm Cancel

Cancel correction.

Let the hour end.

Refuse Cancel

Continue correction.

Hold the hour open.

20. Best Short UI Lines

Use these as flavor lines throughout the game.

The floor is still real here.

Same place.
Different damage.

Find the version that still holds.

The city remembers each version.

Memory has weight.

A bridge lost here may still remember being whole.

You may return.
You may not undo.

The clean version is not always true.

Destruction is also an opening.

Some doors are only memories.

The Core heard you.

The loop is learning you.

The hour is still open.

Do not follow the black coat.

Let the hour end.